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Mandating the Standard Library: Clause 30 - Regular Expressions library

With the adoption of P0788R3, we have a new way of specifying requirements for the library clauses of the standard. This is one of a series of papers reformulating the requirements into the new format. This effort was strongly influenced by the informational paper P1369R0.

The changes in this series of papers fall into three broad categories.

- Change "participate in overload resolution" wording into "Constraints" elements
- Change "Requires" elements into either "Mandates" or "Expects", depending (mostly) on whether or not they can be checked at compile time.
- Drive-by fixes (hopefully very few)

This paper covers Clause 30 (Regular Expressions), and is based on N4830.

The entire clause is reproduced here, but the changes are confined to a few sections:

- re.badexp [30.6](#)
- re.results.acc [30.10.4](#)
- re.traits [30.7](#)
- re.results.form [30.10.5](#)
- re.regex.construct [30.8.1](#)
- re.alg.match [30.11.2](#)
- re.regex.assign [30.8.2](#)
- re.alg.search [30.11.3](#)
- re.results.const [30.10.1](#)

Drive-by fixes:

- In [re.regex.construct] and [re.regex.assign], I strengthened some of the preconditions. "p is not a null pointer" -> "[p, p+len) is a valid range"
- "De-shalled" re.traits/1 ([30.7](#)).
- reworded a bunch of constructor details in re.badexp ([30.6](#)), re.regex.construct ([30.8.1](#)), and re.results.const ([30.10.1](#)).

Open questions:

- Should I "de-shall" the entries in table 135 and 136? - Answer: can be done editorially.

Changes from R0:

- Updated to N4830
- Minor spelling and layout fixes

Changes from R1:

- Changes from teleconference review 11-Oct
- Use "Effects: equivalent to:" throughout [re.regex.assign]
- Removed a couple more useless paragraphs in [re.regex.assign]/1 and /3
- Changes from LWG review in Belfast.

Thanks to Daniel Krügler for his advice and reviews.

Help for the editors: The changes here can be viewed as latex sources with the following commands

```
git clone git@github.com:mclow/mandate.git
cd mandate
git diff master..chapter30 regex.tex
```

30 Regular expressions library [re]

30.1 General [re.general]

- ¹ This Clause describes components that C++ programs may use to perform operations involving regular expression matching and searching.
- ² The following subclauses describe a basic regular expression class template and its traits that can handle char-like (??) template arguments, two specializations of this class template that handle sequences of `char` and `wchar_t`, a class template that holds the result of a regular expression match, a series of algorithms that allow a character sequence to be operated upon by a regular expression, and two iterator types for enumerating regular expression matches, as summarized in [Table 133](#).

Table 133: Regular expressions library summary [tab:re.summary]

	Subclause	Header
30.2	Definitions	
30.3	Requirements	
30.5	Constants	<code><regex></code>
30.6	Exception type	
30.7	Traits	
30.8	Regular expression template	
30.9	Submatches	
30.10	Match results	
30.11	Algorithms	
30.12	Iterators	
30.13	Grammar	

30.2 Definitions [re.def]

- ¹ The following definitions shall apply to this Clause:

30.2.1 [defns.regex.collating.element]

collating element

a sequence of one or more characters within the current locale that collate as if they were a single character.

30.2.2 [defns.regex.finite.state.machine]

finite state machine

an unspecified data structure that is used to represent a regular expression, and which permits efficient matches against the regular expression to be obtained.

30.2.3 [defns.regex.format.specifier]

format specifier

a sequence of one or more characters that is to be replaced with some part of a regular expression match.

30.2.4 [defns.regex.matched]

matched

a sequence of zero or more characters is matched by a regular expression when the characters in the sequence correspond to a sequence of characters defined by the pattern.

30.2.5 [defns.regex.primary.equivalence.class]

primary equivalence class

a set of one or more characters which share the same primary sort key: that is the sort key weighting that depends only upon character shape, and not accents, case, or locale specific tailorings.

30.2.6**[defns.regex.regular.expression]****regular expression**

a pattern that selects specific strings from a set of character strings.

30.2.7**[defns.regex.subexpression]****sub-expression**

a subset of a regular expression that has been marked by parenthesis.

30.3 Requirements**[re.req]**

- ¹ This subclause defines requirements on classes representing regular expression traits. *[Note: The class template `regex_traits`, defined in 30.7, meets these requirements. — end note]*
- ² The class template `basic_regex`, defined in 30.8, needs a set of related types and functions to complete the definition of its semantics. These types and functions are provided as a set of member *typedef-names* and functions in the template parameter `traits` used by the `basic_regex` class template. This subclause defines the semantics of these members.
- ³ To specialize class template `basic_regex` for a character container `CharT` and its related regular expression traits class `Traits`, use `basic_regex<CharT, Traits>`.
- ⁴ In Table 134 *X* denotes a traits class defining types and functions for the character container type `charT`; *u* is an object of type *X*; *v* is an object of type `const X`; *p* is a value of type `const charT*`; *I1* and *I2* are input iterators (*??*); *F1* and *F2* are forward iterators (*??*); *c* is a value of type `const charT`; *s* is an object of type `X::string_type`; *cs* is an object of type `const X::string_type`; *b* is a value of type `bool`; *I* is a value of type `int`; *cl* is an object of type `X::char_class_type`, and *loc* is an object of type `X::locale_type`.

Table 134: Regular expression traits class requirements [tab:re.req]

Expression	Return type	Assertion/note pre-/post-condition
<code>X::char_type</code>	<code>charT</code>	The character container type used in the implementation of class template <code>basic_regex</code> .
<code>X::string_type</code>	<code>basic_string<charT></code>	
<code>X::locale_type</code>	A copy constructible type	A type that represents the locale used by the traits class.
<code>X::char_class_type</code>	A bitmask type (<i>??</i>).	A bitmask type representing a particular character classification.
<code>X::length(p)</code>	<code>size_t</code>	Yields the smallest <i>i</i> such that <code>p[i] == 0</code> . Complexity is linear in <i>i</i> .
<code>v.translate(c)</code>	<code>X::char_type</code>	Returns a character such that for any character <i>d</i> that is to be considered equivalent to <i>c</i> then <code>v.translate(c) == v.translate(d)</code> .
<code>v.translate_nocase(c)</code>	<code>X::char_type</code>	For all characters <i>C</i> that are to be considered equivalent to <i>c</i> when comparisons are to be performed without regard to case, then <code>v.translate_nocase(c) == v.translate_nocase(C)</code> .
<code>v.transform(F1, F2)</code>	<code>X::string_type</code>	Returns a sort key for the character sequence designated by the iterator range <code>[F1, F2)</code> such that if the character sequence <code>[G1, G2)</code> sorts before the character sequence <code>[H1, H2)</code> then <code>v.transform(G1, G2) < v.transform(H1, H2)</code> .

Table 134: Regular expression traits class requirements (continued)

Expression	Return type	Assertion/note pre-/post-condition
<code>v.transform_primary(F1, F2)</code>	<code>X::string_type</code>	Returns a sort key for the character sequence designated by the iterator range <code>[F1, F2)</code> such that if the character sequence <code>[G1, G2)</code> sorts before the character sequence <code>[H1, H2)</code> when character case is not considered then <code>v.transform_primary(G1, G2) < v.transform_primary(H1, H2)</code> .
<code>v.lookup_collatename(F1, F2)</code>	<code>X::string_type</code>	Returns a sequence of characters that represents the collating element consisting of the character sequence designated by the iterator range <code>[F1, F2)</code> . Returns an empty string if the character sequence is not a valid collating element.
<code>v.lookup_classname(F1, F2, b)</code>	<code>X::char_class_type</code>	Converts the character sequence designated by the iterator range <code>[F1, F2)</code> into a value of a bitmask type that can subsequently be passed to <code>isctype</code> . Values returned from <code>lookup_classname</code> can be bitwise OR'ed together; the resulting value represents membership in either of the corresponding character classes. If <code>b</code> is <code>true</code> , the returned bitmask is suitable for matching characters without regard to their case. Returns 0 if the character sequence is not the name of a character class recognized by <code>X</code> . The value returned shall be independent of the case of the characters in the sequence.
<code>v.isctype(c, cl)</code>	<code>bool</code>	Returns <code>true</code> if character <code>c</code> is a member of one of the character classes designated by <code>cl</code> , <code>false</code> otherwise.
<code>v.value(c, I)</code>	<code>int</code>	Returns the value represented by the digit <code>c</code> in base <code>I</code> if the character <code>c</code> is a valid digit in base <code>I</code> ; otherwise returns -1. [Note: The value of <code>I</code> will only be 8, 10, or 16. — end note]
<code>u.imbue(loc)</code>	<code>X::locale_type</code>	Imbues <code>u</code> with the locale <code>loc</code> and returns the previous locale used by <code>u</code> if any.
<code>v.getloc()</code>	<code>X::locale_type</code>	Returns the current locale used by <code>v</code> , if any.

- ⁵ [Note: Class template `regex_traits` meets the requirements for a regular expression traits class when it is specialized for `char` or `wchar_t`. This class template is described in the header `<regex>`, and is described in 30.7. — end note]

30.4 Header `<regex>` synopsis

[re.syn]

```
#include <initializer_list>

namespace std {
    // 30.5, regex constants
    namespace regex_constants {
        using syntax_option_type = T1;
        using match_flag_type = T2;
        using error_type = T3;
    }

    // 30.6, class regex_error
    class regex_error;
```

```

// 30.7, class template regex_traits
template<class charT> struct regex_traits;

// 30.8, class template basic_regex
template<class charT, class traits = regex_traits<charT>> class basic_regex;

using regex = basic_regex<char>;
using wregex = basic_regex<wchar_t>;

// 30.8.5, basic_regex swap
template<class charT, class traits>
    void swap(basic_regex<charT, traits>& e1, basic_regex<charT, traits>& e2);

// 30.9, class template sub_match
template<class BidirectionalIterator>
    class sub_match;

using csub_match = sub_match<const char*>;
using wsub_match = sub_match<const wchar_t*>;
using ssub_match = sub_match<string::const_iterator>;
using wssub_match = sub_match<wstring::const_iterator>;

// 30.9.2, sub_match non-member operators
template<class BiIter>
    bool operator==(const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs, const sub_match<BiIter>& rhs);
template<class BiIter>
    auto operator<=>(const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs, const sub_match<BiIter>& rhs);

template<class BiIter, class ST, class SA>
    bool operator==(
        const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs,
        const basic_string<typename iterator_traits<BiIter>::value_type, ST, SA>& rhs);
template<class BiIter, class ST, class SA>
    auto operator<=>(
        const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs,
        const basic_string<typename iterator_traits<BiIter>::value_type, ST, SA>& rhs);

template<class BiIter>
    bool operator==(const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs,
        const typename iterator_traits<BiIter>::value_type* rhs);
template<class BiIter>
    auto operator<=>(const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs,
        const typename iterator_traits<BiIter>::value_type* rhs);

template<class BiIter>
    bool operator==(const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs,
        const typename iterator_traits<BiIter>::value_type& rhs);
template<class BiIter>
    auto operator<=>(const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs,
        const typename iterator_traits<BiIter>::value_type& rhs);

template<class charT, class ST, class BiIter>
    basic_ostream<charT, ST>&
        operator<<(basic_ostream<charT, ST>& os, const sub_match<BiIter>& m);

// 30.10, class template match_results
template<class BidirectionalIterator,
    class Allocator = allocator<sub_match<BidirectionalIterator>>>
    class match_results;

using cmatch = match_results<const char*>;
using wcmatch = match_results<const wchar_t*>;
using smatch = match_results<string::const_iterator>;
using wsmatch = match_results<wstring::const_iterator>;

```

```

// match_results comparisons
template<class BidirectionalIterator, class Allocator>
    bool operator==(const match_results<BidirectionalIterator, Allocator>& m1,
                    const match_results<BidirectionalIterator, Allocator>& m2);

// 30.10.7, match_results swap
template<class BidirectionalIterator, class Allocator>
    void swap(match_results<BidirectionalIterator, Allocator>& m1,
              match_results<BidirectionalIterator, Allocator>& m2);

// 30.11.2, function template regex_match
template<class BidirectionalIterator, class Allocator, class charT, class traits>
    bool regex_match(BidirectionalIterator first, BidirectionalIterator last,
                    match_results<BidirectionalIterator, Allocator>& m,
                    const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                    regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
template<class BidirectionalIterator, class charT, class traits>
    bool regex_match(BidirectionalIterator first, BidirectionalIterator last,
                    const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                    regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
template<class charT, class Allocator, class traits>
    bool regex_match(const charT* str, match_results<const charT*, Allocator>& m,
                    const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                    regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
template<class ST, class SA, class Allocator, class charT, class traits>
    bool regex_match(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& s,
                    match_results<typename basic_string<charT, ST, SA>::const_iterator,
                                Allocator>& m,
                    const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                    regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
template<class ST, class SA, class Allocator, class charT, class traits>
    bool regex_match(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>&&,
                    match_results<typename basic_string<charT, ST, SA>::const_iterator,
                                Allocator>&,
                    const basic_regex<charT, traits>&,
                    regex_constants::match_flag_type = regex_constants::match_default) = delete;
template<class charT, class traits>
    bool regex_match(const charT* str,
                    const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                    regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
template<class ST, class SA, class charT, class traits>
    bool regex_match(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& s,
                    const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                    regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);

// 30.11.3, function template regex_search
template<class BidirectionalIterator, class Allocator, class charT, class traits>
    bool regex_search(BidirectionalIterator first, BidirectionalIterator last,
                    match_results<BidirectionalIterator, Allocator>& m,
                    const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                    regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
template<class BidirectionalIterator, class charT, class traits>
    bool regex_search(BidirectionalIterator first, BidirectionalIterator last,
                    const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                    regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
template<class charT, class Allocator, class traits>
    bool regex_search(const charT* str,
                    match_results<const charT*, Allocator>& m,
                    const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                    regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
template<class charT, class traits>
    bool regex_search(const charT* str,
                    const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                    regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);

```

```

template<class ST, class SA, class charT, class traits>
    bool regex_search(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& s,
                      const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                      regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
template<class ST, class SA, class Allocator, class charT, class traits>
    bool regex_search(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& s,
                      match_results<typename basic_string<charT, ST, SA>::const_iterator,
                      Allocator>& m,
                      const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                      regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
template<class ST, class SA, class Allocator, class charT, class traits>
    bool regex_search(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>&&,
                      match_results<typename basic_string<charT, ST, SA>::const_iterator,
                      Allocator>&,
                      const basic_regex<charT, traits>&,
                      regex_constants::match_flag_type
                      = regex_constants::match_default) = delete;

// 30.11.4, function template regex_replace
template<class OutputIterator, class BidirectionalIterator,
        class traits, class charT, class ST, class SA>
    OutputIterator
        regex_replace(OutputIterator out,
                      BidirectionalIterator first, BidirectionalIterator last,
                      const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                      const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& fmt,
                      regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
template<class OutputIterator, class BidirectionalIterator, class traits, class charT>
    OutputIterator
        regex_replace(OutputIterator out,
                      BidirectionalIterator first, BidirectionalIterator last,
                      const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                      const charT* fmt,
                      regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
template<class traits, class charT, class ST, class SA, class FST, class FSA>
    basic_string<charT, ST, SA>
        regex_replace(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& s,
                      const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                      const basic_string<charT, FST, FSA>& fmt,
                      regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
template<class traits, class charT, class ST, class SA>
    basic_string<charT, ST, SA>
        regex_replace(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& s,
                      const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                      const charT* fmt,
                      regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
template<class traits, class charT, class ST, class SA>
    basic_string<charT>
        regex_replace(const charT* s,
                      const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                      const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& fmt,
                      regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
template<class traits, class charT>
    basic_string<charT>
        regex_replace(const charT* s,
                      const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                      const charT* fmt,
                      regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);

// 30.12.1, class template regex_iterator
template<class BidirectionalIterator,
        class charT = typename iterator_traits<BidirectionalIterator>::value_type,
        class traits = regex_traits<charT>>
    class regex_iterator;

```

```

using cregex_iterator = regex_iterator<const char*>;
using wcregex_iterator = regex_iterator<const wchar_t*>;
using sregex_iterator = regex_iterator<string::const_iterator>;
using wsregex_iterator = regex_iterator<wstring::const_iterator>;

// 30.12.2, class template regex_token_iterator
template<class BidirectionalIterator,
        class charT = typename iterator_traits<BidirectionalIterator>::value_type,
        class traits = regex_traits<charT>>
    class regex_token_iterator;

using cregex_token_iterator = regex_token_iterator<const char*>;
using wcregex_token_iterator = regex_token_iterator<const wchar_t*>;
using sregex_token_iterator = regex_token_iterator<string::const_iterator>;
using wsregex_token_iterator = regex_token_iterator<wstring::const_iterator>;

namespace pmr {
    template<class BidirectionalIterator>
        using match_results =
            std::match_results<BidirectionalIterator,
                            polymorphic_allocator<sub_match<BidirectionalIterator>>>;

    using cmatch = match_results<const char*>;
    using wcmatch = match_results<const wchar_t*>;
    using smatch = match_results<string::const_iterator>;
    using wsmatch = match_results<wstring::const_iterator>;
}
}

```

30.5 Namespace `std::regex_constants`

[re.const]

- ¹ The namespace `std::regex_constants` holds symbolic constants used by the regular expression library. This namespace provides three types, `syntax_option_type`, `match_flag_type`, and `error_type`, along with several constants of these types.

30.5.1 Bitmask type `syntax_option_type`

[re.synopt]

```

namespace std::regex_constants {
    using syntax_option_type = T1;
    inline constexpr syntax_option_type icaise = unspecified;
    inline constexpr syntax_option_type nosubs = unspecified;
    inline constexpr syntax_option_type optimize = unspecified;
    inline constexpr syntax_option_type collate = unspecified;
    inline constexpr syntax_option_type ECMAScript = unspecified;
    inline constexpr syntax_option_type basic = unspecified;
    inline constexpr syntax_option_type extended = unspecified;
    inline constexpr syntax_option_type awk = unspecified;
    inline constexpr syntax_option_type grep = unspecified;
    inline constexpr syntax_option_type egrep = unspecified;
    inline constexpr syntax_option_type multiline = unspecified;
}

```

- ¹ The type `syntax_option_type` is an implementation-defined bitmask type (??). Setting its elements has the effects listed in Table 135. A valid value of type `syntax_option_type` shall have at most one of the grammar elements `ECMAScript`, `basic`, `extended`, `awk`, `grep`, `egrep`, `set`. If no grammar element is set, the default grammar is `ECMAScript`.

30.5.2 Bitmask type `match_flag_type`

[re.matchflag]

```

namespace std::regex_constants {
    using match_flag_type = T2;
    inline constexpr match_flag_type match_default = {};
    inline constexpr match_flag_type match_not_bol = unspecified;
    inline constexpr match_flag_type match_not_eol = unspecified;
    inline constexpr match_flag_type match_not_bow = unspecified;
    inline constexpr match_flag_type match_not_eow = unspecified;
}

```

Table 135: `syntax_option_type` effects [tab:re.synopt]

Element	Effect(s) if set
<code>icase</code>	Specifies that matching of regular expressions against a character container sequence shall be performed without regard to case.
<code>nosubs</code>	Specifies that no sub-expressions shall be considered to be marked, so that when a regular expression is matched against a character container sequence, no sub-expression matches shall be stored in the supplied <code>match_results</code> object.
<code>optimize</code>	Specifies that the regular expression engine should pay more attention to the speed with which regular expressions are matched, and less to the speed with which regular expression objects are constructed. Otherwise it has no detectable effect on the program output.
<code>collate</code>	Specifies that character ranges of the form "[a-b]" shall be locale sensitive.
<code>ECMAScript</code>	Specifies that the grammar recognized by the regular expression engine shall be that used by ECMAScript in ECMA-262, as modified in 30.13. SEE ALSO: ECMA-262 15.10
<code>basic</code>	Specifies that the grammar recognized by the regular expression engine shall be that used by basic regular expressions in POSIX. SEE ALSO: POSIX, Base Definitions and Headers, Section 9.3
<code>extended</code>	Specifies that the grammar recognized by the regular expression engine shall be that used by extended regular expressions in POSIX. SEE ALSO: POSIX, Base Definitions and Headers, Section 9.4
<code>awk</code>	Specifies that the grammar recognized by the regular expression engine shall be that used by the utility <code>awk</code> in POSIX.
<code>grep</code>	Specifies that the grammar recognized by the regular expression engine shall be that used by the utility <code>grep</code> in POSIX.
<code>egrep</code>	Specifies that the grammar recognized by the regular expression engine shall be that used by the utility <code>grep</code> when given the <code>-E</code> option in POSIX.
<code>multiline</code>	Specifies that <code>^</code> shall match the beginning of a line and <code>\$</code> shall match the end of a line, if the <code>ECMAScript</code> engine is selected.

```

inline constexpr match_flag_type match_any = unspecified;
inline constexpr match_flag_type match_not_null = unspecified;
inline constexpr match_flag_type match_continuous = unspecified;
inline constexpr match_flag_type match_prev_avail = unspecified;
inline constexpr match_flag_type format_default = {};
inline constexpr match_flag_type format_sed = unspecified;
inline constexpr match_flag_type format_no_copy = unspecified;
inline constexpr match_flag_type format_first_only = unspecified;
}

```

- ¹ The type `match_flag_type` is an implementation-defined bitmask type (??). The constants of that type, except for `match_default` and `format_default`, are bitmask elements. The `match_default` and `format_default` constants are empty bitmasks. Matching a regular expression against a sequence of characters [`first`, `last`) proceeds according to the rules of the grammar specified for the regular expression object, modified according to the effects listed in Table 136 for any bitmask elements set.

Table 136: `regex_constants::match_flag_type` effects when obtaining a match against a character container sequence [`first`, `last`). [tab:re.matchflag]

Element	Effect(s) if set
<code>match_not BOL</code>	The first character in the sequence [<code>first</code> , <code>last</code>) shall be treated as though it is not at the beginning of a line, so the character <code>^</code> in the regular expression shall not match [<code>first</code> , <code>first</code>).

Table 136: `regex_constants::match_flag_type` effects when obtaining a match against a character container sequence `[first, last)`. (continued)

Element	Effect(s) if set
<code>match_not_eol</code>	The last character in the sequence <code>[first, last)</code> shall be treated as though it is not at the end of a line, so the character "\$" in the regular expression shall not match <code>[last, last)</code> .
<code>match_not_bow</code>	The expression "\\b" shall not match the sub-sequence <code>[first, first)</code> .
<code>match_not_eow</code>	The expression "\\b" shall not match the sub-sequence <code>[last, last)</code> .
<code>match_any</code>	If more than one match is possible then any match is an acceptable result.
<code>match_not_null</code>	The expression shall not match an empty sequence.
<code>match_continuous</code>	The expression shall only match a sub-sequence that begins at <code>first</code> .
<code>match_prev_avail</code>	--first is a valid iterator position. When this flag is set the flags <code>match_not_bol</code> and <code>match_not_bow</code> shall be ignored by the regular expression algorithms (30.11) and iterators (30.12).
<code>format_default</code>	When a regular expression match is to be replaced by a new string, the new string shall be constructed using the rules used by the ECMAScript replace function in ECMA-262, part 15.5.4.11 String.prototype.replace. In addition, during search and replace operations all non-overlapping occurrences of the regular expression shall be located and replaced, and sections of the input that did not match the expression shall be copied unchanged to the output string.
<code>format_sed</code>	When a regular expression match is to be replaced by a new string, the new string shall be constructed using the rules used by the sed utility in POSIX.
<code>format_no_copy</code>	During a search and replace operation, sections of the character container sequence being searched that do not match the regular expression shall not be copied to the output string.
<code>format_first_only</code>	When specified during a search and replace operation, only the first occurrence of the regular expression shall be replaced.

30.5.3 Implementation-defined error_type

[re.err]

```

namespace std::regex_constants {
    using error_type = T3;
    inline constexpr error_type error_collate = unspecified;
    inline constexpr error_type error_ctype = unspecified;
    inline constexpr error_type error_escape = unspecified;
    inline constexpr error_type error_backref = unspecified;
    inline constexpr error_type error_brack = unspecified;
    inline constexpr error_type error_paren = unspecified;
    inline constexpr error_type error_brace = unspecified;
    inline constexpr error_type error_badbrace = unspecified;
    inline constexpr error_type error_range = unspecified;
    inline constexpr error_type error_space = unspecified;
    inline constexpr error_type error_badrepeat = unspecified;
    inline constexpr error_type error_complexity = unspecified;
    inline constexpr error_type error_stack = unspecified;
}

```

- ¹ The type `error_type` is an implementation-defined enumerated type (??). Values of type `error_type` represent the error conditions described in Table 137:

Table 137: `error_type` values in the C locale [tab:re.err]

Value	Error condition
<code>error_collate</code>	The expression contained an invalid collating element name.
<code>error_ctype</code>	The expression contained an invalid character class name.
<code>error_escape</code>	The expression contained an invalid escaped character, or a trailing escape.
<code>error_backref</code>	The expression contained an invalid back reference.
<code>error_brack</code>	The expression contained mismatched [and].
<code>error_paren</code>	The expression contained mismatched (and).

Table 137: `error_type` values in the C locale (continued)

Value	Error condition
<code>error_brace</code>	The expression contained mismatched { and }
<code>error_badbrace</code>	The expression contained an invalid range in a { } expression.
<code>error_range</code>	The expression contained an invalid character range, such as [b-a] in most encodings.
<code>error_space</code>	There was insufficient memory to convert the expression into a finite state machine.
<code>error_badrepeat</code>	One of *?+{ was not preceded by a valid regular expression.
<code>error_complexity</code>	The complexity of an attempted match against a regular expression exceeded a pre-set level.
<code>error_stack</code>	There was insufficient memory to determine whether the regular expression could match the specified character sequence.

30.6 Class `regex_error`

[re.badexp]

```
class regex_error : public runtime_error {
public:
    explicit regex_error(regex_constants::error_type ecode);
    regex_constants::error_type code() const;
};
```

- ¹ The class `regex_error` defines the type of objects thrown as exceptions to report errors from the regular expression library.

```
regex_error(regex_constants::error_type ecode);
```

- ² ~~*Effects:* Constructs an object of class `regex_error`.~~

- ³ *Ensures:* `ecode == code()`.

```
regex_constants::error_type code() const;
```

- ⁴ *Returns:* The error code that was passed to the constructor.

30.7 Class template `regex_traits`

[re.traits]

```
namespace std {
    template<class charT>
        struct regex_traits {
            using char_type      = charT;
            using string_type     = basic_string<char_type>;
            using locale_type     = locale;
            using char_class_type = bitmask_type;

            regex_traits();
            static size_t length(const char_type* p);
            charT translate(charT c) const;
            charT translate_nocase(charT c) const;
            template<class ForwardIterator>
                string_type transform(ForwardIterator first, ForwardIterator last) const;
            template<class ForwardIterator>
                string_type transform_primary(
                    ForwardIterator first, ForwardIterator last) const;
            template<class ForwardIterator>
                string_type lookup_collatename(
                    ForwardIterator first, ForwardIterator last) const;
            template<class ForwardIterator>
                char_class_type lookup_classname(
                    ForwardIterator first, ForwardIterator last, bool icase = false) const;
            bool isctype(charT c, char_class_type f) const;
            int value(charT ch, int radix) const;
            locale_type imbue(locale_type l);
            locale_type getloc() const;
        };
}
```

```
};
}
```

- 1 The specializations `regex_traits<char>` and `regex_traits<wchar_t>` ~~shall be valid and shall~~ meet the requirements for a regular expression traits class (30.3).

```
using char_class_type = bitmask_type;
```

- 2 The type `char_class_type` is used to represent a character classification and is capable of holding an implementation specific set returned by `lookup_classname`.

```
static size_t length(const char_type* p);
```

- 3 *Returns:* `char_traits<charT>::length(p)`.

```
charT translate(charT c) const;
```

- 4 *Returns:* `c`.

```
charT translate_nocase(charT c) const;
```

- 5 *Returns:* `use_facet<ctype<charT>>(getloc()).tolower(c)`.

```
template<class ForwardIterator>
```

```
string_type transform(ForwardIterator first, ForwardIterator last) const;
```

- 6 *Effects:* As if by:

```
string_type str(first, last);
return use_facet<collate<charT>>(
    getloc()).transform(str.data(), str.data() + str.length());
```

```
template<class ForwardIterator>
```

```
string_type transform_primary(ForwardIterator first, ForwardIterator last) const;
```

- 7 *Effects:* If

```
typeid(use_facet<collate<charT>>) == typeid(collate_byname<charT>)
```

and the form of the sort key returned by `collate_byname<charT>::transform(first, last)` is known and can be converted into a primary sort key then returns that key, otherwise returns an empty string.

```
template<class ForwardIterator>
```

```
string_type lookup_collatename(ForwardIterator first, ForwardIterator last) const;
```

- 8 *Returns:* A sequence of one or more characters that represents the collating element consisting of the character sequence designated by the iterator range `[first, last)`. Returns an empty string if the character sequence is not a valid collating element.

```
template<class ForwardIterator>
```

```
char_class_type lookup_classname(
```

```
ForwardIterator first, ForwardIterator last, bool icase = false) const;
```

- 9 *Returns:* An unspecified value that represents the character classification named by the character sequence designated by the iterator range `[first, last)`. If the parameter `icase` is `true` then the returned mask identifies the character classification without regard to the case of the characters being matched, otherwise it does honor the case of the characters being matched.³²⁶ The value returned shall be independent of the case of the characters in the character sequence. If the name is not recognized then returns `char_class_type()`.

- 10 *Remarks:* For `regex_traits<char>`, at least the narrow character names in Table 138 shall be recognized. For `regex_traits<wchar_t>`, at least the wide character names in Table 138 shall be recognized.

```
bool isctype(charT c, char_class_type f) const;
```

- 11 *Effects:* Determines if the character `c` is a member of the character classification represented by `f`.

- 12 *Returns:* Given the following function declaration:

³²⁶ For example, if the parameter `icase` is `true` then `[[:lower:]]` is the same as `[[:alpha:]]`.

// for exposition only

```
template<class C>
    ctype_base::mask convert(typename regex_traits<C>::char_class_type f);
```

that returns a value in which each `ctype_base::mask` value corresponding to a value in `f` named in Table 138 is set, then the result is determined as if by:

```
ctype_base::mask m = convert<charT>(f);
const ctype<charT>& ct = use_facet<ctype<charT>>(getloc());
if (ct.is(m, c)) {
    return true;
} else if (c == ct.widen('_')) {
    charT w[1] = { ct.widen('w') };
    char_class_type x = lookup_classname(w, w+1);
    return (f&x) == x;
} else {
    return false;
}
```

[Example:

```
regex_traits<char> t;
string d("d");
string u("upper");
regex_traits<char>::char_class_type f;
f = t.lookup_classname(d.begin(), d.end());
f |= t.lookup_classname(u.begin(), u.end());
ctype_base::mask m = convert<char>(f); // m == ctype_base::digit|ctype_base::upper
```

— end example] [Example:

```
regex_traits<char> t;
string w("w");
regex_traits<char>::char_class_type f;
f = t.lookup_classname(w.begin(), w.end());
t.isctype('A', f); // returns true
t.isctype('_', f); // returns true
t.isctype(' ', f); // returns false
```

— end example]

```
int value(charT ch, int radix) const;
```

13 ~~Requires:~~ Expects: The value of `radix` shall be 8, 10, or 16.

14 *Returns:* The value represented by the digit `ch` in base `radix` if the character `ch` is a valid digit in base `radix`; otherwise returns -1.

```
locale_type imbue(locale_type loc);
```

15 *Effects:* Imbues `this` with a copy of the locale `loc`. [Note: Calling `imbue` with a different locale than the one currently in use invalidates all cached data held by `*this`. — end note]

16 *Returns:* If no locale has been previously imbued then a copy of the global locale in effect at the time of construction of `*this`, otherwise a copy of the last argument passed to `imbue`.

17 *Ensures:* `getloc() == loc`.

```
locale_type getloc() const;
```

18 *Returns:* If no locale has been imbued then a copy of the global locale in effect at the time of construction of `*this`, otherwise a copy of the last argument passed to `imbue`.

30.8 Class template `basic_regex`

[re.regex]

¹ For a char-like type `charT`, specializations of class template `basic_regex` represent regular expressions constructed from character sequences of `charT` characters. In the rest of 30.8, `charT` denotes a given char-like type. Storage for a regular expression is allocated and freed as necessary by the member functions of class `basic_regex`.

² Objects of type specialization of `basic_regex` are responsible for converting the sequence of `charT` objects to an internal representation. It is not specified what form this representation takes, nor how it is accessed by

Table 138: Character class names and corresponding `ctype` masks [tab:re.traits.classnames]

Narrow character name	Wide character name	Corresponding <code>ctype_base::mask</code> value
"alnum"	L"alnum"	<code>ctype_base::alnum</code>
"alpha"	L"alpha"	<code>ctype_base::alpha</code>
"blank"	L"blank"	<code>ctype_base::blank</code>
"cntrl"	L"cntrl"	<code>ctype_base::cntrl</code>
"digit"	L"digit"	<code>ctype_base::digit</code>
"d"	L"d"	<code>ctype_base::digit</code>
"graph"	L"graph"	<code>ctype_base::graph</code>
"lower"	L"lower"	<code>ctype_base::lower</code>
"print"	L"print"	<code>ctype_base::print</code>
"punct"	L"punct"	<code>ctype_base::punct</code>
"space"	L"space"	<code>ctype_base::space</code>
"s"	L"s"	<code>ctype_base::space</code>
"upper"	L"upper"	<code>ctype_base::upper</code>
"w"	L"w"	<code>ctype_base::alnum</code>
"xdigit"	L"xdigit"	<code>ctype_base::xdigit</code>

algorithms that operate on regular expressions. [Note: Implementations will typically declare some function templates as friends of `basic_regex` to achieve this — *end note*]

- ³ The functions described in this Clause report errors by throwing exceptions of type `regex_error`.

```
namespace std {
    template<class charT, class traits = regex_traits<charT>>
        class basic_regex {
        public:
            // types
            using value_type = charT;
            using traits_type = traits;
            using string_type = typename traits::string_type;
            using flag_type = regex_constants::syntax_option_type;
            using locale_type = typename traits::locale_type;

            // 30.5.1, constants
            static constexpr flag_type icalse = regex_constants::icalse;
            static constexpr flag_type nosubs = regex_constants::nosubs;
            static constexpr flag_type optimize = regex_constants::optimize;
            static constexpr flag_type collate = regex_constants::collate;
            static constexpr flag_type ECMAScript = regex_constants::ECMAScript;
            static constexpr flag_type basic = regex_constants::basic;
            static constexpr flag_type extended = regex_constants::extended;
            static constexpr flag_type awk = regex_constants::awk;
            static constexpr flag_type grep = regex_constants::grep;
            static constexpr flag_type egrep = regex_constants::egrep;
            static constexpr flag_type multiline = regex_constants::multiline;

            // 30.8.1, construct/copy/destroy
            basic_regex();
            explicit basic_regex(const charT* p, flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
            basic_regex(const charT* p, size_t len, flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
            basic_regex(const basic_regex&);
            basic_regex(basic_regex&&) noexcept;
            template<class ST, class SA>
                explicit basic_regex(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& p,
                                    flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
            template<class ForwardIterator>
                basic_regex(ForwardIterator first, ForwardIterator last,
                            flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
            basic_regex(initializer_list<charT>, flag_type = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
```

```

~basic_regex();

basic_regex& operator=(const basic_regex&);
basic_regex& operator=(basic_regex&&) noexcept;
basic_regex& operator=(const charT* ptr);
basic_regex& operator=(initializer_list<charT> il);
template<class ST, class SA>
    basic_regex& operator=(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& p);

// 30.8.2, assign
basic_regex& assign(const basic_regex& that);
basic_regex& assign(basic_regex&& that) noexcept;
basic_regex& assign(const charT* ptr, flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
basic_regex& assign(const charT* p, size_t len, flag_type f);
template<class string_traits, class A>
    basic_regex& assign(const basic_string<charT, string_traits, A>& s,
                        flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
template<class InputIterator>
    basic_regex& assign(InputIterator first, InputIterator last,
                        flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
basic_regex& assign(initializer_list<charT>,
                    flag_type = regex_constants::ECMAScript);

// 30.8.3, const operations
unsigned mark_count() const;
flag_type flags() const;

// 30.8.4, locale
locale_type imbue(locale_type loc);
locale_type getloc() const;

// 30.8.5, swap
void swap(basic_regex&);
};

template<class ForwardIterator>
    basic_regex(ForwardIterator, ForwardIterator,
                regex_constants::syntax_option_type = regex_constants::ECMAScript)
        -> basic_regex<typename iterator_traits<ForwardIterator>::value_type>;
}

```

30.8.1 Constructors

[re.regex.construct]

```
basic_regex();
```

[Editor's note: All through this sub-clause, please move the "Throws:" elements to be after the "Effects:" and "Ensures:" elements.]

- 1 ~~Effects: Constructs an object of class basic_regex that does not match any character sequence.~~
Ensures: *this does not match any character sequence.
- explicit basic_regex(const charT* p, flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
- 2 ~~Requires: p shall not be a null pointer.~~ Expects: [p, p+char_traits<charT>::length(p)) is a valid range.
- 3 ~~Throws: regex_error if p~~ Throws: regex_error if [p, p+char_traits<charT>::length(p)) is not a valid regular expression.
- 4 ~~Effects: Constructs an object of class basic_regex; t~~ The object's internal finite state machine is constructed from the regular expression contained in the array of charT of length char_traits<charT>::length(p) whose first element is designated by p sequence of characters [p, p+char_traits<charT>::length(p)), and interpreted according to the flags f.
- 5 Ensures: flags() returns f. mark_count() returns the number of marked sub-expressions within the expression.
- basic_regex(const charT* p, size_t len, flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
- 6 ~~Requires: p shall not be a null pointer.~~ Expects: [p, p+len) is a valid range.

7 *Throws:* `regex_error` if `p[p, p+len)` is not a valid regular expression.

8 *Effects:* ~~Constructs an object of class `basic_regex`; t~~The object's internal finite state machine is constructed from the regular expression contained in the sequence of characters `[p, p+len)`, and interpreted according to the flags specified in `f`.

9 *Ensures:* `flags()` returns `f`. `mark_count()` returns the number of marked sub-expressions within the expression.

```
basic_regex(const basic_regex& e);
```

10 *Effects:* Constructs an object of class `basic_regex` as a copy of the object `e`.

11 *Ensures:* `flags()` and `mark_count()` return `e.flags()` and `e.mark_count()`, respectively.

```
basic_regex(basic_regex&& e) noexcept;
```

12 *Effects:* Move constructs an object of class `basic_regex` from `e`.

13 *Ensures:* `flags()` and `mark_count()` return the values that `e.flags()` and `e.mark_count()`, respectively, had before construction. ~~`e` is in a valid state with unspecified value.~~

```
template<class ST, class SA>
explicit basic_regex(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& s,
                    flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
```

14 *Throws:* `regex_error` if `s` is not a valid regular expression.

15 *Effects:* ~~Constructs an object of class `basic_regex`; t~~The object's internal finite state machine is constructed from the regular expression contained in the string `s`, and interpreted according to the flags specified in `f`.

16 *Ensures:* `flags()` returns `f`. `mark_count()` returns the number of marked sub-expressions within the expression.

```
template<class ForwardIterator>
basic_regex(ForwardIterator first, ForwardIterator last,
            flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
```

17 *Throws:* `regex_error` if the sequence `[first, last)` is not a valid regular expression.

18 *Effects:* ~~Constructs an object of class `basic_regex`; t~~The object's internal finite state machine is constructed from the regular expression contained in the sequence of characters `[first, last)`, and interpreted according to the flags specified in `f`.

19 *Ensures:* `flags()` returns `f`. `mark_count()` returns the number of marked sub-expressions within the expression.

```
basic_regex(initializer_list<charT> il, flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
```

20 *Effects:* Same as `basic_regex(il.begin(), il.end(), f)`.

30.8.2 Assignment

[re.regex.assign]

```
basic_regex& operator=(const basic_regex& e);
```

1 *Effects:* Copies `e` into `*this` and returns `*this`.

2 *Ensures:* `flags()` and `mark_count()` return `e.flags()` and `e.mark_count()`, respectively.

```
basic_regex& operator=(basic_regex&& e) noexcept;
```

3 *Effects:* Move assigns from `e` into `*this` and returns `*this`.

4 *Ensures:* `flags()` and `mark_count()` return the values that `e.flags()` and `e.mark_count()`, respectively, had before assignment. `e` is in a valid state with unspecified value.

```
basic_regex& operator=(const charT* ptr);
```

5 *Requires:* `ptr` shall not be a null pointer.

6 *Effects:* ~~Returns~~Equivalent to: `return assign(ptr);`

```

basic_regex& operator=(initializer_list<charT> il);
7   Effects: ReturnsEquivalent to: return assign(il.begin(), il.end());;

template<class ST, class SA>
    basic_regex& operator=(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& p);
8   Effects: ReturnsEquivalent to: return assign(p);;

basic_regex& assign(const basic_regex& that);
9   Effects: Equivalent to: return *this = that;;

basic_regex& assign(basic_regex&& that) noexcept;
10  Effects: Equivalent to: return *this = std::move(that);;

basic_regex& assign(const charT* ptr, flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
11  Returns:Effects: Equivalent to: return assign(string_type(ptr), f);;

basic_regex& assign(const charT* ptr, size_t len, flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
12  Returns:Effects: Equivalent to: return assign(string_type(ptr, len), f);;

template<class string_traits, class A>
    basic_regex& assign(const basic_string<charT, string_traits, A>& s,
                       flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
13  Throws: regex_error if s is not a valid regular expression.
14  Returns: *this.
15  Effects: Assigns the regular expression contained in the string s, interpreted according the flags specified
    in f. If an exception is thrown, *this is unchanged.
16  Ensures: If no exception is thrown, flags() returns f and mark_count() returns the number of marked
    sub-expressions within the expression.

template<class InputIterator>
    basic_regex& assign(InputIterator first, InputIterator last,
                       flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
17  Requires: InputIterator shall meet the Cpp17InputIterator requirements (?).
18  Effects: ReturnsEquivalent to: return assign(string_type(first, last), f);;

basic_regex& assign(initializer_list<charT> il,
                    flag_type f = regex_constants::ECMAScript);
19  Effects: Same asEquivalent to: return assign(il.begin(), il.end(), f);;
20  Returns: *this.

```

30.8.3 Constant operations

[re.regex.operations]

```

unsigned mark_count() const;
1   Effects: Returns the number of marked sub-expressions within the regular expression.

flag_type flags() const;
2   Effects: Returns a copy of the regular expression syntax flags that were passed to the object's constructor
    or to the last call to assign.

```

30.8.4 Locale

[re.regex.locale]

```

locale_type imbue(locale_type loc);
1   Effects: Returns the result of traits_inst.imbue(loc) where traits_inst is a (default-initialized)
    instance of the template type argument traits stored within the object. After a call to imbue the
    basic_regex object does not match any character sequence.

```

```
locale_type getloc() const;
```

- 2 *Effects:* Returns the result of `traits_inst.getloc()` where `traits_inst` is a (default-initialized) instance of the template parameter `traits` stored within the object.

30.8.5 Swap

[re.regex.swap]

```
void swap(basic_regex& e);
```

- 1 *Effects:* Swaps the contents of the two regular expressions.
- 2 *Ensures:* `*this` contains the regular expression that was in `e`, `e` contains the regular expression that was in `*this`.
- 3 *Complexity:* Constant time.

30.8.6 Non-member functions

[re.regex.nonmemb]

```
template<class charT, class traits>
void swap(basic_regex<charT, traits>& lhs, basic_regex<charT, traits>& rhs);
```

- 1 *Effects:* Calls `lhs.swap(rhs)`.

30.9 Class template `sub_match`

[re.submatch]

- 1 Class template `sub_match` denotes the sequence of characters matched by a particular marked sub-expression.

```
namespace std {
    template<class BidirectionalIterator>
    class sub_match : public pair<BidirectionalIterator, BidirectionalIterator> {
    public:
        using value_type      =
            typename iterator_traits<BidirectionalIterator>::value_type;
        using difference_type =
            typename iterator_traits<BidirectionalIterator>::difference_type;
        using iterator        = BidirectionalIterator;
        using string_type     = basic_string<value_type>;

        bool matched;

        constexpr sub_match();

        difference_type length() const;
        operator string_type() const;
        string_type str() const;

        int compare(const sub_match& s) const;
        int compare(const string_type& s) const;
        int compare(const value_type* s) const;
    };
}
```

30.9.1 Members

[re.submatch.members]

```
constexpr sub_match();
```

- 1 *Effects:* Value-initializes the `pair` base class subobject and the member `matched`.

```
difference_type length() const;
```

- 2 *Returns:* `matched ? distance(first, second) : 0`.

```
operator string_type() const;
```

- 3 *Returns:* `matched ? string_type(first, second) : string_type()`.

```
string_type str() const;
```

- 4 *Returns:* `matched ? string_type(first, second) : string_type()`.

```
int compare(const sub_match& s) const;
```

5 *Returns:* `str().compare(s.str())`.

```
int compare(const string_type& s) const;
```

6 *Returns:* `str().compare(s)`.

```
int compare(const value_type* s) const;
```

7 *Returns:* `str().compare(s)`.

30.9.2 Non-member operators

[re.submatch.op]

1 Let *SM-CAT*(I) be

```
compare_three_way_result_t<basic_string<typename iterator_traits<I>::value_type>>
```

```
template<class BiIter>
```

```
bool operator==(const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs, const sub_match<BiIter>& rhs);
```

2 *Returns:* `lhs.compare(rhs) == 0`.

```
template<class BiIter>
```

```
auto operator<=>(const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs, const sub_match<BiIter>& rhs);
```

3 *Returns:* `static_cast<SM-CAT(BiIter)>(lhs.compare(rhs) <=> 0)`.

```
template<class BiIter, class ST, class SA>
```

```
bool operator==(
    const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs,
    const basic_string<typename iterator_traits<BiIter>::value_type, ST, SA>& rhs);
```

4 *Returns:*

```
lhs.compare(typename sub_match<BiIter>::string_type(rhs.data(), rhs.size())) == 0
```

```
template<class BiIter, class ST, class SA>
```

```
auto operator<=>(
    const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs,
    const basic_string<typename iterator_traits<BiIter>::value_type, ST, SA>& rhs);
```

5 *Returns:*

```
static_cast<SM-CAT(BiIter)>(lhs.compare(
    typename sub_match<BiIter>::string_type(rhs.data(), rhs.size())
    <=> 0
))
```

```
template<class BiIter>
```

```
bool operator==(const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs,
    const typename iterator_traits<BiIter>::value_type* rhs);
```

6 *Returns:* `lhs.compare(rhs) == 0`.

```
template<class BiIter>
```

```
auto operator<=>(const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs,
    const typename iterator_traits<BiIter>::value_type* rhs);
```

7 *Returns:* `static_cast<SM-CAT(BiIter)>(lhs.compare(rhs) <=> 0)`.

```
template<class BiIter>
```

```
bool operator==(const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs,
    const typename iterator_traits<BiIter>::value_type& rhs);
```

8 *Returns:* `lhs.compare(typename sub_match<BiIter>::string_type(1, rhs)) == 0`.

```
template<class BiIter>
```

```
auto operator<=>(const sub_match<BiIter>& lhs,
    const typename iterator_traits<BiIter>::value_type& rhs);
```

9 *Returns:*

```

        static_cast<SM-CAT(BiIter)>(lhs.compare(
            typename sub_match<BiIter>::string_type(1, rhs))
            <=> 0
        )

template<class charT, class ST, class BiIter>
    basic_ostream<charT, ST>&
        operator<<(basic_ostream<charT, ST>& os, const sub_match<BiIter>& m);
10     Returns: os << m.str().

```

30.10 Class template `match_results`

[re.results]

- ¹ Class template `match_results` denotes a collection of character sequences representing the result of a regular expression match. Storage for the collection is allocated and freed as necessary by the member functions of class template `match_results`.
- ² The class template `match_results` meets the requirements of an allocator-aware container and of a sequence container (??, ??) except that only copy assignment, move assignment, and operations defined for const-qualified sequence containers are supported and that the semantics of comparison functions are different from those required for a container.
- ³ A default-constructed `match_results` object has no fully established result state. A match result is *ready* when, as a consequence of a completed regular expression match modifying such an object, its result state becomes fully established. The effects of calling most member functions from a `match_results` object that is not ready are undefined.
- ⁴ The `sub_match` object stored at index 0 represents sub-expression 0, i.e., the whole match. In this case the `sub_match` member `matched` is always `true`. The `sub_match` object stored at index `n` denotes what matched the marked sub-expression `n` within the matched expression. If the sub-expression `n` participated in a regular expression match then the `sub_match` member `matched` evaluates to `true`, and members `first` and `second` denote the range of characters `[first, second)` which formed that match. Otherwise `matched` is `false`, and members `first` and `second` point to the end of the sequence that was searched. [Note: The `sub_match` objects representing different sub-expressions that did not participate in a regular expression match need not be distinct. — end note]

```

namespace std {
    template<class BidirectionalIterator,
            class Allocator = allocator<sub_match<BidirectionalIterator>>>
        class match_results {
        public:
            using value_type      = sub_match<BidirectionalIterator>;
            using const_reference = const value_type&;
            using reference        = value_type&;
            using const_iterator  = implementation-defined;
            using iterator        = const_iterator;
            using difference_type =
                typename iterator_traits<BidirectionalIterator>::difference_type;
            using size_type       = typename allocator_traits<Allocator>::size_type;
            using allocator_type   = Allocator;
            using char_type       =
                typename iterator_traits<BidirectionalIterator>::value_type;
            using string_type     = basic_string<char_type>;

            // 30.10.1, construct/copy/destroy
            match_results() : match_results(Allocator()) {}
            explicit match_results(const Allocator&);
            match_results(const match_results& m);
            match_results(match_results&& m) noexcept;
            match_results& operator=(const match_results& m);
            match_results& operator=(match_results&& m);
            ~match_results();

            // 30.10.2, state
            bool ready() const;

```

```

// 30.10.3, size
size_type size() const;
size_type max_size() const;
[[nodiscard]] bool empty() const;

// 30.10.4, element access
difference_type length(size_type sub = 0) const;
difference_type position(size_type sub = 0) const;
string_type str(size_type sub = 0) const;
const_reference operator[](size_type n) const;

const_reference prefix() const;
const_reference suffix() const;
const_iterator begin() const;
const_iterator end() const;
const_iterator cbegin() const;
const_iterator cend() const;

// 30.10.5, format
template<class OutputIter>
OutputIter
    format(OutputIter out,
            const char_type* fmt_first, const char_type* fmt_last,
            regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::format_default) const;
template<class OutputIter, class ST, class SA>
OutputIter
    format(OutputIter out,
            const basic_string<char_type, ST, SA>& fmt,
            regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::format_default) const;
template<class ST, class SA>
basic_string<char_type, ST, SA>
    format(const basic_string<char_type, ST, SA>& fmt,
            regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::format_default) const;
string_type
    format(const char_type* fmt,
            regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::format_default) const;

// 30.10.6, allocator
allocator_type get_allocator() const;

// 30.10.7, swap
void swap(match_results& that);
};
}

```

30.10.1 Constructors

[re.results.const]

```
explicit match_results(const Allocator& a);
```

1 *Effects:* Constructs an object of class `match_results`.

2 *Ensures:* `ready()` returns false. `size()` returns 0.

```
match_results(const match_results& m);
```

3 *Effects:* Constructs an object of class `match_results`, as a copy of `m`.

```
match_results(match_results&& m) noexcept;
```

4 *Effects:* Move constructs an object of class `match_results` from `m` satisfying the same postconditions as Table 139. Additionally, the stored `Allocator` value is move constructed from `m.get_allocator()`.

5 *Effects:* The stored `Allocator` value is move constructed from `m.get_allocator()`.

6 *Ensures:* As specified in Table 139.

7 *Throws:* Nothing.

```
match_results& operator=(const match_results& m);
```

8 *Effects:* Assigns `m` to `*this`. The postconditions of this function are indicated in Table 139.

9 *Ensures:* As specified in Table 139.

```
match_results& operator=(match_results&& m);
```

10 *Effects:* Move-assigns `m` to `*this`. The postconditions of this function are indicated in Table 139.

11 *Ensures:* As specified in Table 139.

Table 139: `match_results` assignment operator effects [tab:re.results.const]

Element	Value
<code>ready()</code>	<code>m.ready()</code>
<code>size()</code>	<code>m.size()</code>
<code>str(n)</code>	<code>m.str(n)</code> for all integers <code>n < m.size()</code>
<code>prefix()</code>	<code>m.prefix()</code>
<code>suffix()</code>	<code>m.suffix()</code>
<code>(*this)[n]</code>	<code>m[n]</code> for all integers <code>n < m.size()</code>
<code>length(n)</code>	<code>m.length(n)</code> for all integers <code>n < m.size()</code>
<code>position(n)</code>	<code>m.position(n)</code> for all integers <code>n < m.size()</code>

30.10.2 State

[re.results.state]

```
bool ready() const;
```

1 *Returns:* true if `*this` has a fully established result state, otherwise false.

30.10.3 Size

[re.results.size]

```
size_type size() const;
```

1 *Returns:* One plus the number of marked sub-expressions in the regular expression that was matched if `*this` represents the result of a successful match. Otherwise returns 0. [Note: The state of a `match_results` object can be modified only by passing that object to `regex_match` or `regex_search`. Subclauses 30.11.2 and 30.11.3 specify the effects of those algorithms on their `match_results` arguments. — end note]

```
size_type max_size() const;
```

2 *Returns:* The maximum number of `sub_match` elements that can be stored in `*this`.

```
[[nodiscard]] bool empty() const;
```

3 *Returns:* `size() == 0`.

30.10.4 Element access

[re.results.acc]

```
difference_type length(size_type sub = 0) const;
```

1 ~~*Requires:*~~ *Expects:* `ready() == true`.

2 *Returns:* `(*this)[sub].length()`.

```
difference_type position(size_type sub = 0) const;
```

3 ~~*Requires:*~~ *Expects:* `ready() == true`.

4 *Returns:* The distance from the start of the target sequence to `(*this)[sub].first`.

```
string_type str(size_type sub = 0) const;
```

5 ~~*Requires:*~~ *Expects:* `ready() == true`.

6 *Returns:* `string_type((*this)[sub])`.

```
const_reference operator[](size_type n) const;
```

7 ~~Requires:~~ Expects: ready() == true.

8 *Returns:* A reference to the `sub_match` object representing the character sequence that matched marked sub-expression `n`. If `n == 0` then returns a reference to a `sub_match` object representing the character sequence that matched the whole regular expression. If `n >= size()` then returns a `sub_match` object representing an unmatched sub-expression.

```
const_reference prefix() const;
```

9 ~~Requires:~~ Expects: ready() == true.

10 *Returns:* A reference to the `sub_match` object representing the character sequence from the start of the string being matched/searched to the start of the match found.

```
const_reference suffix() const;
```

11 ~~Requires:~~ Expects: ready() == true.

12 *Returns:* A reference to the `sub_match` object representing the character sequence from the end of the match found to the end of the string being matched/searched.

```
const_iterator begin() const;
```

```
const_iterator cbegin() const;
```

13 *Returns:* A starting iterator that enumerates over all the sub-expressions stored in `*this`.

```
const_iterator end() const;
```

```
const_iterator cend() const;
```

14 *Returns:* A terminating iterator that enumerates over all the sub-expressions stored in `*this`.

30.10.5 Formatting

[re.results.form]

```
template<class OutputIter>
```

```
OutputIter format(
```

```
OutputIter out,
```

```
const char_type* fmt_first, const char_type* fmt_last,
```

```
regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::format_default) const;
```

1 ~~Requires:~~ Expects: ready() == true and `OutputIter` ~~shall meet~~ meets the requirements for a *Cpp17OutputIterator* (??).

2 *Effects:* Copies the character sequence `[fmt_first, fmt_last)` to `OutputIter out`. Replaces each format specifier or escape sequence in the copied range with either the character(s) it represents or the sequence of characters within `*this` to which it refers. The bitmasks specified in `flags` determine which format specifiers and escape sequences are recognized.

3 *Returns:* `out`.

```
template<class OutputIter, class ST, class SA>
```

```
OutputIter format(
```

```
OutputIter out,
```

```
const basic_string<char_type, ST, SA>& fmt,
```

```
regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::format_default) const;
```

4 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
return format(out, fmt.data(), fmt.data() + fmt.size(), flags);
```

```
template<class ST, class SA>
```

```
basic_string<char_type, ST, SA> format(
```

```
const basic_string<char_type, ST, SA>& fmt,
```

```
regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::format_default) const;
```

5 ~~Requires:~~ Expects: ready() == true.

6 *Effects:* Constructs an empty string result of type `basic_string<char_type, ST, SA>` and calls:

```
format(back_inserter(result), fmt, flags);
```

7 *Returns:* `result`.

```

string_type format(
    const char_type* fmt,
    regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::format_default) const;
8   Requires: Expects: ready() == true.
9   Effects: Constructs an empty string result of type string_type and calls:
        format(back_inserter(result), fmt, fmt + char_traits<char_type>::length(fmt), flags);
10  Returns: result.

```

30.10.6 Allocator

[re.results.all]

```
allocator_type get_allocator() const;
```

1 *Returns:* A copy of the Allocator that was passed to the object's constructor or, if that allocator has been replaced, a copy of the most recent replacement.

30.10.7 Swap

[re.results.swap]

```
void swap(match_results& that);
```

1 *Effects:* Swaps the contents of the two sequences.

2 *Ensures:* *this contains the sequence of matched sub-expressions that were in that, that contains the sequence of matched sub-expressions that were in *this.

3 *Complexity:* Constant time.

```

template<class BidirectionalIterator, class Allocator>
void swap(match_results<BidirectionalIterator, Allocator>& m1,
          match_results<BidirectionalIterator, Allocator>& m2);

```

4 *Effects:* As if by m1.swap(m2).

30.10.8 Non-member functions

[re.results.nonmember]

```

template<class BidirectionalIterator, class Allocator>
bool operator==(const match_results<BidirectionalIterator, Allocator>& m1,
                const match_results<BidirectionalIterator, Allocator>& m2);

```

1 *Returns:* true if neither match result is ready, false if one match result is ready and the other is not. If both match results are ready, returns true only if:

(1.1) — m1.empty() && m2.empty(), or

(1.2) — !m1.empty() && !m2.empty(), and the following conditions are satisfied:

(1.2.1) — m1.prefix() == m2.prefix(),

(1.2.2) — m1.size() == m2.size() && equal(m1.begin(), m1.end(), m2.begin()), and

(1.2.3) — m1.suffix() == m2.suffix().

[Note: The algorithm equal is defined in ?? — end note]

30.11 Regular expression algorithms

[re.alg]

30.11.1 Exceptions

[re.except]

1 The algorithms described in this subclause may throw an exception of type regex_error. If such an exception e is thrown, e.code() shall return either regex_constants::error_complexity or regex_constants::error_stack.

30.11.2 regex_match

[re.alg.match]

```

template<class BidirectionalIterator, class Allocator, class charT, class traits>
bool regex_match(BidirectionalIterator first, BidirectionalIterator last,
                 match_results<BidirectionalIterator, Allocator>& m,
                 const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                 regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);

```

1 ~~Requires:~~ Expects: The type BidirectionalIterator shall ~~meet~~ meet the Cpp17BidirectionalIterator requirements (??).

- 2 *Effects:* Determines whether there is a match between the regular expression **e**, and all of the character sequence **[first, last)**. The parameter **flags** is used to control how the expression is matched against the character sequence. When determining if there is a match, only potential matches that match the entire character sequence are considered. Returns **true** if such a match exists, **false** otherwise. [Example:

```
std::regex re("Get|GetValue");
std::cmatch m;
regex_search("GetValue", m, re);           // returns true, and m[0] contains "Get"
regex_match ("GetValue", m, re);           // returns true, and m[0] contains "GetValue"
regex_search("GetValues", m, re);          // returns true, and m[0] contains "Get"
regex_match ("GetValues", m, re);          // returns false
```

— end example]

- 3 *Ensures:* **m.ready() == true** in all cases. If the function returns **false**, then the effect on parameter **m** is unspecified except that **m.size()** returns 0 and **m.empty()** returns **true**. Otherwise the effects on parameter **m** are given in Table 140.

Table 140: Effects of `regex_match` algorithm [tab:re.alg.match]

Element	Value
m.size()	1 + e.mark_count()
m.empty()	false
m.prefix().first	first
m.prefix().second	first
m.prefix().matched	false
m.suffix().first	last
m.suffix().second	last
m.suffix().matched	false
m[0].first	first
m[0].second	last
m[0].matched	true
m[n].first	For all integers $0 < n < m.size()$, the start of the sequence that matched sub-expression n . Alternatively, if sub-expression n did not participate in the match, then last .
m[n].second	For all integers $0 < n < m.size()$, the end of the sequence that matched sub-expression n . Alternatively, if sub-expression n did not participate in the match, then last .
m[n].matched	For all integers $0 < n < m.size()$, true if sub-expression n participated in the match, false otherwise.

```
template<class BidirectionalIterator, class charT, class traits>
bool regex_match(BidirectionalIterator first, BidirectionalIterator last,
                 const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                 regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

- 4 *Effects:* Behaves “as if” by constructing an instance of `match_results<BidirectionalIterator>` **what**, and then returning the result of `regex_match(first, last, what, e, flags)`.

```
template<class charT, class Allocator, class traits>
bool regex_match(const charT* str,
                 match_results<const charT*, Allocator>& m,
                 const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                 regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

- 5 *Returns:* `regex_match(str, str + char_traits<charT>::length(str), m, e, flags)`.

```
template<class ST, class SA, class Allocator, class charT, class traits>
bool regex_match(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& s,
                 match_results<typename basic_string<charT, ST, SA>::const_iterator,
                             Allocator>& m,
                 const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                 regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

6 *Returns:* `regex_match(s.begin(), s.end(), m, e, flags)`.

```
template<class charT, class traits>
bool regex_match(const charT* str,
                 const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                 regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

7 *Returns:* `regex_match(str, str + char_traits<charT>::length(str), e, flags)`

```
template<class ST, class SA, class charT, class traits>
bool regex_match(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& s,
                 const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                 regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

8 *Returns:* `regex_match(s.begin(), s.end(), e, flags)`.

30.11.3 regex_search

[re.alg.search]

```
template<class BidirectionalIterator, class Allocator, class charT, class traits>
bool regex_search(BidirectionalIterator first, BidirectionalIterator last,
                  match_results<BidirectionalIterator, Allocator>& m,
                  const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                  regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

1 ~~*Requires:*~~ *Expects:* Type `BidirectionalIterator` ~~shall meet~~meets the *Cpp17BidirectionalIterator* requirements (??).

2 *Effects:* Determines whether there is some sub-sequence within `[first, last)` that matches the regular expression `e`. The parameter `flags` is used to control how the expression is matched against the character sequence. Returns `true` if such a sequence exists, `false` otherwise.

3 *Ensures:* `m.ready() == true` in all cases. If the function returns `false`, then the effect on parameter `m` is unspecified except that `m.size()` returns 0 and `m.empty()` returns `true`. Otherwise the effects on parameter `m` are given in Table 141.

Table 141: Effects of `regex_search` algorithm [tab:re.alg.search]

Element	Value
<code>m.size()</code>	<code>1 + e.mark_count()</code>
<code>m.empty()</code>	<code>false</code>
<code>m.prefix().first</code>	<code>first</code>
<code>m.prefix().second</code>	<code>m[0].first</code>
<code>m.prefix().matched</code>	<code>m.prefix().first != m.prefix().second</code>
<code>m.suffix().first</code>	<code>m[0].second</code>
<code>m.suffix().second</code>	<code>last</code>
<code>m.suffix().matched</code>	<code>m.suffix().first != m.suffix().second</code>
<code>m[0].first</code>	The start of the sequence of characters that matched the regular expression
<code>m[0].second</code>	The end of the sequence of characters that matched the regular expression
<code>m[0].matched</code>	<code>true</code>
<code>m[n].first</code>	For all integers <code>0 < n < m.size()</code> , the start of the sequence that matched sub-expression <code>n</code> . Alternatively, if sub-expression <code>n</code> did not participate in the match, then <code>last</code> .

Table 141: Effects of `regex_search` algorithm (continued)

Element	Value
<code>m[n].second</code>	For all integers $0 < n < m.size()$, the end of the sequence that matched sub-expression <code>n</code> . Alternatively, if sub-expression <code>n</code> did not participate in the match, then <code>last</code> .
<code>m[n].matched</code>	For all integers $0 < n < m.size()$, true if sub-expression <code>n</code> participated in the match, false otherwise.

```
template<class charT, class Allocator, class traits>
bool regex_search(const charT* str, match_results<const charT*, Allocator>& m,
                  const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                  regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

4 *Returns:* `regex_search(str, str + char_traits<charT>::length(str), m, e, flags)`.

```
template<class ST, class SA, class Allocator, class charT, class traits>
bool regex_search(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& s,
                  match_results<typename basic_string<charT, ST, SA>::const_iterator,
                              Allocator>& m,
                  const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                  regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

5 *Returns:* `regex_search(s.begin(), s.end(), m, e, flags)`.

```
template<class BidirectionalIterator, class charT, class traits>
bool regex_search(BidirectionalIterator first, BidirectionalIterator last,
                  const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                  regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

6 *Effects:* Behaves “as if” by constructing an object what of type `match_results<BidirectionalIterator>` and returning `regex_search(first, last, what, e, flags)`.

```
template<class charT, class traits>
bool regex_search(const charT* str,
                  const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                  regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

7 *Returns:* `regex_search(str, str + char_traits<charT>::length(str), e, flags)`.

```
template<class ST, class SA, class charT, class traits>
bool regex_search(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& s,
                  const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                  regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

8 *Returns:* `regex_search(s.begin(), s.end(), e, flags)`.

30.11.4 `regex_replace`

[re.alg.replace]

```
template<class OutputIterator, class BidirectionalIterator,
        class traits, class charT, class ST, class SA>
OutputIterator
regex_replace(OutputIterator out,
              BidirectionalIterator first, BidirectionalIterator last,
              const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
              const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& fmt,
              regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

```
template<class OutputIterator, class BidirectionalIterator, class traits, class charT>
OutputIterator
regex_replace(OutputIterator out,
              BidirectionalIterator first, BidirectionalIterator last,
              const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
              const charT* fmt,
              regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

1 *Effects:* Constructs a `regex_iterator` object `i` as if by

```
    regex_iterator<BidirectionalIterator, charT, traits> i(first, last, e, flags)
```

and uses `i` to enumerate through all of the matches `m` of type `match_results<BidirectionalIterator>` that occur within the sequence `[first, last)`. If no such matches are found and `!(flags & regex_constants::format_no_copy)`, then calls

```
    out = copy(first, last, out)
```

If any matches are found then, for each such match:

- (1.1) — If `!(flags & regex_constants::format_no_copy)`, calls

```
    out = copy(m.prefix().first, m.prefix().second, out)
```

- (1.2) — Then calls

```
    out = m.format(out, fmt, flags)
```

for the first form of the function and

```
    out = m.format(out, fmt, fmt + char_traits<charT>::length(fmt), flags)
```

for the second.

Finally, if such a match is found and `!(flags & regex_constants::format_no_copy)`, calls

```
    out = copy(last_m.suffix().first, last_m.suffix().second, out)
```

where `last_m` is a copy of the last match found. If `flags & regex_constants::format_first_only` is nonzero, then only the first match found is replaced.

2 *Returns:* `out`.

```
template<class traits, class charT, class ST, class SA, class FST, class FSA>
basic_string<charT, ST, SA>
    regex_replace(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& s,
                  const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                  const basic_string<charT, FST, FSA>& fmt,
                  regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

```
template<class traits, class charT, class ST, class SA>
basic_string<charT, ST, SA>
    regex_replace(const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& s,
                  const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                  const charT* fmt,
                  regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

3 *Effects:* Constructs an empty string result of type `basic_string<charT, ST, SA>` and calls:

```
    regex_replace(back_inserter(result), s.begin(), s.end(), e, fmt, flags);
```

4 *Returns:* `result`.

```
template<class traits, class charT, class ST, class SA>
basic_string<charT>
    regex_replace(const charT* s,
                  const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                  const basic_string<charT, ST, SA>& fmt,
                  regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

```
template<class traits, class charT>
basic_string<charT>
    regex_replace(const charT* s,
                  const basic_regex<charT, traits>& e,
                  const charT* fmt,
                  regex_constants::match_flag_type flags = regex_constants::match_default);
```

5 *Effects:* Constructs an empty string result of type `basic_string<charT>` and calls:

```
    regex_replace(back_inserter(result), s, s + char_traits<charT>::length(s), e, fmt, flags);
```

6 *Returns:* `result`.

30.12 Regular expression iterators

[re.iter]

30.12.1 Class template `regex_iterator`

[re.regiter]

- ¹ The class template `regex_iterator` is an iterator adaptor. It represents a new view of an existing iterator sequence, by enumerating all the occurrences of a regular expression within that sequence. A `regex_iterator` uses `regex_search` to find successive regular expression matches within the sequence from which it was constructed. After the iterator is constructed, and every time `operator++` is used, the iterator finds and stores a value of `match_results<BidirectionalIterator>`. If the end of the sequence is reached (`regex_search` returns `false`), the iterator becomes equal to the end-of-sequence iterator value. The default constructor constructs an end-of-sequence iterator object, which is the only legitimate iterator to be used for the end condition. The result of `operator*` on an end-of-sequence iterator is not defined. For any other iterator value a `const match_results<BidirectionalIterator>&` is returned. The result of `operator->` on an end-of-sequence iterator is not defined. For any other iterator value a `const match_results<BidirectionalIterator>*` is returned. It is impossible to store things into `regex_iterators`. Two end-of-sequence iterators are always equal. An end-of-sequence iterator is not equal to a non-end-of-sequence iterator. Two non-end-of-sequence iterators are equal when they are constructed from the same arguments.

```
namespace std {
    template<class BidirectionalIterator,
            class charT = typename iterator_traits<BidirectionalIterator>::value_type,
            class traits = regex_traits<charT>>
    class regex_iterator {
    public:
        using regex_type          = basic_regex<charT, traits>;
        using iterator_category    = forward_iterator_tag;
        using value_type           = match_results<BidirectionalIterator>;
        using difference_type      = ptrdiff_t;
        using pointer               = const value_type*;
        using reference             = const value_type&;

        regex_iterator();
        regex_iterator(BidirectionalIterator a, BidirectionalIterator b,
                     const regex_type& re,
                     regex_constants::match_flag_type m = regex_constants::match_default);
        regex_iterator(BidirectionalIterator, BidirectionalIterator,
                     const regex_type&&,
                     regex_constants::match_flag_type = regex_constants::match_default) = delete;
        regex_iterator(const regex_iterator&);
        regex_iterator& operator=(const regex_iterator&);
        bool operator==(const regex_iterator&) const;
        const value_type& operator*() const;
        const value_type* operator->() const;
        regex_iterator& operator++();
        regex_iterator operator++(int);

    private:
        BidirectionalIterator begin; // exposition only
        BidirectionalIterator end;   // exposition only
        const regex_type* pregex;    // exposition only
        regex_constants::match_flag_type flags; // exposition only
        match_results<BidirectionalIterator> match; // exposition only
    };
}
```

- ² An object of type `regex_iterator` that is not an end-of-sequence iterator holds a *zero-length match* if `match[0].matched == true` and `match[0].first == match[0].second`. [Note: For example, this can occur when the part of the regular expression that matched consists only of an assertion (such as `'^'`, `'$'`, `'\b'`, `'\B'`). — end note]

30.12.1.1 Constructors

[re.regiter.cnstr]

```
regex_iterator();
```

- ¹ *Effects:* Constructs an end-of-sequence iterator.

```

regex_iterator(BidirectionalIterator a, BidirectionalIterator b,
               const regex_type& re,
               regex_constants::match_flag_type m = regex_constants::match_default);

```

- 2 *Effects:* Initializes `begin` and `end` to `a` and `b`, respectively, sets `pregex` to `addressof(re)`, sets `flags` to `m`, then calls `regex_search(begin, end, match, *pregex, flags)`. If this call returns `false` the constructor sets `*this` to the end-of-sequence iterator.

30.12.1.2 Comparisons

[re.regiter.comp]

```
bool operator==(const regex_iterator& right) const;
```

- 1 *Returns:* `true` if `*this` and `right` are both end-of-sequence iterators or if the following conditions all hold:

- (1.1) — `begin == right.begin`,
- (1.2) — `end == right.end`,
- (1.3) — `pregex == right.pregex`,
- (1.4) — `flags == right.flags`, and
- (1.5) — `match[0] == right.match[0]`;

otherwise `false`.

30.12.1.3 Indirection

[re.regiter.deref]

```
const value_type& operator*() const;
```

- 1 *Returns:* `match`.

```
const value_type* operator->() const;
```

- 2 *Returns:* `addressof(match)`.

30.12.1.4 Increment

[re.regiter.incr]

```
regex_iterator& operator++();
```

- 1 *Effects:* Constructs a local variable `start` of type `BidirectionalIterator` and initializes it with the value of `match[0].second`.

- 2 If the iterator holds a zero-length match and `start == end` the operator sets `*this` to the end-of-sequence iterator and returns `*this`.

- 3 Otherwise, if the iterator holds a zero-length match, the operator calls:

```

regex_search(start, end, match, *pregex,
             flags | regex_constants::match_not_null | regex_constants::match_continuous)

```

If the call returns `true` the operator returns `*this`. Otherwise the operator increments `start` and continues as if the most recent match was not a zero-length match.

- 4 If the most recent match was not a zero-length match, the operator sets `flags` to `flags | regex_constants::match_prev_avail` and calls `regex_search(start, end, match, *pregex, flags)`. If the call returns `false` the iterator sets `*this` to the end-of-sequence iterator. The iterator then returns `*this`.

- 5 In all cases in which the call to `regex_search` returns `true`, `match.prefix().first` shall be equal to the previous value of `match[0].second`, and for each index `i` in the half-open range `[0, match.size())` for which `match[i].matched` is `true`, `match.position(i)` shall return `distance(begin, match[i].first)`.

- 6 [Note: This means that `match.position(i)` gives the offset from the beginning of the target sequence, which is often not the same as the offset from the sequence passed in the call to `regex_search`. — end note]

- 7 It is unspecified how the implementation makes these adjustments.

- 8 [Note: This means that a compiler may call an implementation-specific search function, in which case a program-defined specialization of `regex_search` will not be called. — end note]

```
regex_iterator operator++(int);
```

9 *Effects:* As if by:

```
    regex_iterator tmp = *this;
    ++(*this);
    return tmp;
```

30.12.2 Class template `regex_token_iterator`

[re.tokiter]

- 1 The class template `regex_token_iterator` is an iterator adaptor; that is to say it represents a new view of an existing iterator sequence, by enumerating all the occurrences of a regular expression within that sequence, and presenting one or more sub-expressions for each match found. Each position enumerated by the iterator is a `sub_match` class template instance that represents what matched a particular sub-expression within the regular expression.
- 2 When class `regex_token_iterator` is used to enumerate a single sub-expression with index -1 the iterator performs field splitting: that is to say it enumerates one sub-expression for each section of the character container sequence that does not match the regular expression specified.
- 3 After it is constructed, the iterator finds and stores a value `regex_iterator<BidirectionalIterator>` `position` and sets the internal count `N` to zero. It also maintains a sequence `subs` which contains a list of the sub-expressions which will be enumerated. Every time `operator++` is used the count `N` is incremented; if `N` exceeds or equals `subs.size()`, then the iterator increments member `position` and sets count `N` to zero.
- 4 If the end of sequence is reached (`position` is equal to the end of sequence iterator), the iterator becomes equal to the end-of-sequence iterator value, unless the sub-expression being enumerated has index -1, in which case the iterator enumerates one last sub-expression that contains all the characters from the end of the last regular expression match to the end of the input sequence being enumerated, provided that this would not be an empty sub-expression.
- 5 The default constructor constructs an end-of-sequence iterator object, which is the only legitimate iterator to be used for the end condition. The result of `operator*` on an end-of-sequence iterator is not defined. For any other iterator value a `const sub_match<BidirectionalIterator>&` is returned. The result of `operator->` on an end-of-sequence iterator is not defined. For any other iterator value a `const sub_match<BidirectionalIterator>*` is returned.
- 6 It is impossible to store things into `regex_token_iterators`. Two end-of-sequence iterators are always equal. An end-of-sequence iterator is not equal to a non-end-of-sequence iterator. Two non-end-of-sequence iterators are equal when they are constructed from the same arguments.

```
namespace std {
    template<class BidirectionalIterator,
            class charT = typename iterator_traits<BidirectionalIterator>::value_type,
            class traits = regex_traits<charT>>
    class regex_token_iterator {
    public:
        using regex_type      = basic_regex<charT, traits>;
        using iterator_category = forward_iterator_tag;
        using value_type      = sub_match<BidirectionalIterator>;
        using difference_type  = ptrdiff_t;
        using pointer          = const value_type*;
        using reference         = const value_type&;

        regex_token_iterator();
        regex_token_iterator(BidirectionalIterator a, BidirectionalIterator b,
                            const regex_type& re,
                            int submatch = 0,
                            regex_constants::match_flag_type m =
                                regex_constants::match_default);
        regex_token_iterator(BidirectionalIterator a, BidirectionalIterator b,
                            const regex_type& re,
                            const vector<int>& submatches,
                            regex_constants::match_flag_type m =
                                regex_constants::match_default);
    };
}
```

```

    regex_token_iterator(BidirectionalIterator a, BidirectionalIterator b,
                        const regex_type& re,
                        initializer_list<int> submatches,
                        regex_constants::match_flag_type m =
                            regex_constants::match_default);
template<size_t N>
    regex_token_iterator(BidirectionalIterator a, BidirectionalIterator b,
                        const regex_type& re,
                        const int (&submatches)[N],
                        regex_constants::match_flag_type m =
                            regex_constants::match_default);
    regex_token_iterator(BidirectionalIterator a, BidirectionalIterator b,
                        const regex_type&& re,
                        int submatch = 0,
                        regex_constants::match_flag_type m =
                            regex_constants::match_default) = delete;
    regex_token_iterator(BidirectionalIterator a, BidirectionalIterator b,
                        const regex_type&& re,
                        const vector<int>& submatches,
                        regex_constants::match_flag_type m =
                            regex_constants::match_default) = delete;
    regex_token_iterator(BidirectionalIterator a, BidirectionalIterator b,
                        const regex_type&& re,
                        initializer_list<int> submatches,
                        regex_constants::match_flag_type m =
                            regex_constants::match_default) = delete;

template<size_t N>
    regex_token_iterator(BidirectionalIterator a, BidirectionalIterator b,
                        const regex_type&& re,
                        const int (&submatches)[N],
                        regex_constants::match_flag_type m =
                            regex_constants::match_default) = delete;
    regex_token_iterator(const regex_token_iterator&);
    regex_token_iterator& operator=(const regex_token_iterator&);
    bool operator==(const regex_token_iterator&) const;
    const value_type& operator*() const;
    const value_type* operator->() const;
    regex_token_iterator& operator++();
    regex_token_iterator operator++(int);

private:
    using position_iterator =
        regex_iterator<BidirectionalIterator, charT, traits>; // exposition only
    position_iterator position; // exposition only
    const value_type* result; // exposition only
    value_type suffix; // exposition only
    size_t N; // exposition only
    vector<int> subs; // exposition only
};
}

```

⁷ A *suffix iterator* is a `regex_token_iterator` object that points to a final sequence of characters at the end of the target sequence. In a suffix iterator the member `result` holds a pointer to the data member `suffix`, the value of the member `suffix.match` is `true`, `suffix.first` points to the beginning of the final sequence, and `suffix.second` points to the end of the final sequence.

⁸ [Note: For a suffix iterator, data member `suffix.first` is the same as the end of the last match found, and `suffix.second` is the same as the end of the target sequence — *end note*]

⁹ The *current match* is `(*position).prefix()` if `subs[N] == -1`, or `(*position)[subs[N]]` for any other value of `subs[N]`.

30.12.2.1 Constructors

[re.tokiter.cnstr]

```
regex_token_iterator();
```

1 *Effects:* Constructs the end-of-sequence iterator.

```
regex_token_iterator(BidirectionalIterator a, BidirectionalIterator b,
                    const regex_type& re,
                    int submatch = 0,
                    regex_constants::match_flag_type m = regex_constants::match_default);
```

```
regex_token_iterator(BidirectionalIterator a, BidirectionalIterator b,
                    const regex_type& re,
                    const vector<int>& submatches,
                    regex_constants::match_flag_type m = regex_constants::match_default);
```

```
regex_token_iterator(BidirectionalIterator a, BidirectionalIterator b,
                    const regex_type& re,
                    initializer_list<int> submatches,
                    regex_constants::match_flag_type m = regex_constants::match_default);
```

```
template<size_t N>
    regex_token_iterator(BidirectionalIterator a, BidirectionalIterator b,
                        const regex_type& re,
                        const int (&submatches)[N],
                        regex_constants::match_flag_type m = regex_constants::match_default);
```

2 ~~*Requires:*~~ *Expects:* Each of the initialization values of submatches shall be `is >= -1`.

3 *Effects:* The first constructor initializes the member `subs` to hold the single value `submatch`. The second, third, and fourth constructors initialize the member `subs` to hold a copy of the sequence of integer values pointed to by the iterator range `[begin(submatches), end(submatches))`.

4 Each constructor then sets `N` to 0, and `position` to `position_iterator(a, b, re, m)`. If `position` is not an end-of-sequence iterator the constructor sets `result` to the address of the current match. Otherwise if any of the values stored in `subs` is equal to -1 the constructor sets `*this` to a suffix iterator that points to the range `[a, b)`, otherwise the constructor sets `*this` to an end-of-sequence iterator.

30.12.2.2 Comparisons

[re.tokiter.comp]

```
bool operator==(const regex_token_iterator& right) const;
```

1 *Returns:* true if `*this` and `right` are both end-of-sequence iterators, or if `*this` and `right` are both suffix iterators and `suffix == right.suffix`; otherwise returns false if `*this` or `right` is an end-of-sequence iterator or a suffix iterator. Otherwise returns true if `position == right.position`, `N == right.N`, and `subs == right.subs`. Otherwise returns false.

30.12.2.3 Indirection

[re.tokiter.deref]

```
const value_type& operator*() const;
```

1 *Returns:* `*result`.

```
const value_type* operator->() const;
```

2 *Returns:* `result`.

30.12.2.4 Increment

[re.tokiter.incr]

```
regex_token_iterator& operator++();
```

1 *Effects:* Constructs a local variable `prev` of type `position_iterator`, initialized with the value of `position`.

2 If `*this` is a suffix iterator, sets `*this` to an end-of-sequence iterator.

3 Otherwise, if `N + 1 < subs.size()`, increments `N` and sets `result` to the address of the current match.

4 Otherwise, sets `N` to 0 and increments `position`. If `position` is not an end-of-sequence iterator the operator sets `result` to the address of the current match.

5 Otherwise, if any of the values stored in `subs` is equal to -1 and `prev->suffix().length()` is not 0 the operator sets `*this` to a suffix iterator that points to the range `[prev->suffix().first, prev->suffix().second)`.

6 Otherwise, sets `*this` to an end-of-sequence iterator.

7 *Returns:* `*this`

```
regex_token_iterator& operator++(int);
```

8 *Effects:* Constructs a copy `tmp` of `*this`, then calls `++(*this)`.

9 *Returns:* `tmp`.

30.13 Modified ECMAScript regular expression grammar [re.grammar]

1 The regular expression grammar recognized by `basic_regex` objects constructed with the ECMAScript flag is that specified by ECMA-262, except as specified below.

2 Objects of type specialization of `basic_regex` store within themselves a default-constructed instance of their `traits` template parameter, henceforth referred to as `traits_inst`. This `traits_inst` object is used to support localization of the regular expression; `basic_regex` member functions shall not call any locale dependent C or C++ API, including the formatted string input functions. Instead they shall call the appropriate traits member function to achieve the required effect.

3 The following productions within the ECMAScript grammar are modified as follows:

```
ClassAtom ::
-
ClassAtomNoDash
ClassAtomExClass
ClassAtomCollatingElement
ClassAtomEquivalence
```

```
IdentityEscape ::
SourceCharacter but not c
```

4 The following new productions are then added:

```
ClassAtomExClass ::
[: ClassName :]
```

```
ClassAtomCollatingElement ::
[. ClassName .]
```

```
ClassAtomEquivalence ::
[= ClassName =]
```

```
ClassName ::
ClassNameCharacter
ClassNameCharacter ClassName
```

```
ClassNameCharacter ::
SourceCharacter but not one of "." "=" ":"
```

5 The productions `ClassAtomExClass`, `ClassAtomCollatingElement` and `ClassAtomEquivalence` provide functionality equivalent to that of the same features in regular expressions in POSIX.

6 The regular expression grammar may be modified by any `regex_constants::syntax_option_type` flags specified when constructing an object of type specialization of `basic_regex` according to the rules in [Table 135](#).

7 A `ClassName` production, when used in `ClassAtomExClass`, is not valid if `traits_inst.lookup_classname` returns zero for that name. The names recognized as valid `ClassNames` are determined by the type of the traits class, but at least the following names shall be recognized: `alnum`, `alpha`, `blank`, `cntrl`, `digit`, `graph`, `lower`, `print`, `punct`, `space`, `upper`, `xdigit`, `d`, `s`, `w`. In addition the following expressions shall be equivalent:

```
\d and [[:digit:]]
```

```
\D and [^[:digit:]]
```

`\s` and `[[:space:]]`

`\S` and `[^[:space:]]`

`\w` and `[_[:alnum:]]`

`\W` and `[^_[:alnum:]]`

- 8 A `ClassName` production when used in a `ClassAtomCollatingElement` production is not valid if the value returned by `traits_inst.lookup_collatename` for that name is an empty string.
- 9 The results from multiple calls to `traits_inst.lookup_classname` can be bitwise OR'ed together and subsequently passed to `traits_inst.isctype`.
- 10 A `ClassName` production when used in a `ClassAtomEquivalence` production is not valid if the value returned by `traits_inst.lookup_collatename` for that name is an empty string or if the value returned by `traits_inst.transform_primary` for the result of the call to `traits_inst.lookup_collatename` is an empty string.
- 11 When the sequence of characters being transformed to a finite state machine contains an invalid class name the translator shall throw an exception object of type `regex_error`.
- 12 If the *CV* of a *UnicodeEscapeSequence* is greater than the largest value that can be held in an object of type `charT` the translator shall throw an exception object of type `regex_error`. [Note: This means that values of the form "uxxxx" that do not fit in a character are invalid. — end note]
- 13 Where the regular expression grammar requires the conversion of a sequence of characters to an integral value, this is accomplished by calling `traits_inst.value`.
- 14 The behavior of the internal finite state machine representation when used to match a sequence of characters is as described in ECMA-262. The behavior is modified according to any `match_flag_type` flags (30.5.2) specified when using the regular expression object in one of the regular expression algorithms (30.11). The behavior is also localized by interaction with the traits class template parameter as follows:
 - (14.1) — During matching of a regular expression finite state machine against a sequence of characters, two characters `c` and `d` are compared using the following rules:
 - (14.1.1) — if `(flags() & regex_constants::icase)` the two characters are equal if `traits_inst.translate_nocase(c) == traits_inst.translate_nocase(d)`;
 - (14.1.2) — otherwise, if `flags() & regex_constants::collate` the two characters are equal if `traits_inst.translate(c) == traits_inst.translate(d)`;
 - (14.1.3) — otherwise, the two characters are equal if `c == d`.
 - (14.2) — During matching of a regular expression finite state machine against a sequence of characters, comparison of a collating element range `c1-c2` against a character `c` is conducted as follows: if `flags() & regex_constants::collate` is false then the character `c` is matched if `c1 <= c && c <= c2`, otherwise `c` is matched in accordance with the following algorithm:


```
string_type str1 = string_type(1,
    flags() & icase ?
        traits_inst.translate_nocase(c1) : traits_inst.translate(c1));
string_type str2 = string_type(1,
    flags() & icase ?
        traits_inst.translate_nocase(c2) : traits_inst.translate(c2));
string_type str = string_type(1,
    flags() & icase ?
        traits_inst.translate_nocase(c) : traits_inst.translate(c));
return traits_inst.transform(str1.begin(), str1.end())
    <= traits_inst.transform(str.begin(), str.end())
    && traits_inst.transform(str.begin(), str.end())
    <= traits_inst.transform(str2.begin(), str2.end());
```
 - (14.3) — During matching of a regular expression finite state machine against a sequence of characters, testing whether a collating element is a member of a primary equivalence class is conducted by first converting the collating element and the equivalence class to sort keys using `traits::transform_primary`, and then comparing the sort keys for equality.

- (14.4) — During matching of a regular expression finite state machine against a sequence of characters, a character `c` is a member of a character class designated by an iterator range `[first, last)` if `traits_inst.isctype(c, traits_inst.lookup_classname(first, last, flags() & icafe))` is `true`.

SEE ALSO: ECMA-262 15.10